

Pitfalls in the security and surveillance industry

- Lack of standardisation with an absence of legislative support for local manufacturing.
- Lack of awareness on security and a significantly large unorganised sector.
- Price sensitivity is also considered as a major issue as many view investments on security systems as frivolous and not a necessity.
- High import duties and taxes inflating prices for a market reliant on imports is another major concern for the industry and customers.
- Lack of many comprehensive or end-to-end solution providers is another disadvantage as customers are forced to scout the market from multiple entities, which is tedious and augments the system integration costs.

— Contributed by Yajan Dua, research analyst,
Aerospace and Defence, MarketsandMarkets

year growth of 45 per cent for the next four to five years."

While corporate surveillance requirements are generally driven by the need to protect employees and company assets, these help achieve other business objectives also. "In airports, an intelligent video system measures the queue time between entering and exiting a check-in point, helping direct staff and minimising the waiting time for travellers. In banks, remote surveillance and monitoring can help prevent theft, fraud and facilitate investigation," says Dua. Digital or IP-based cameras can also add to business intelligence. He adds, "In retail outlets, camera footage can help to analyse customer footfall and patterns, reduce shrinkage, enhance marketing and optimise staffing. Network video helps retailers manage the inventory life cycle more efficiently."

Domestic production is microscopic

Although the growth has been slow, video surveillance market is gaining solid grounds in India due to security concerns, government initiatives and growing awareness. Cameras constitute a major portion of cost in the surveillance systems and are extensively imported from countries such as China, Taiwan, Korea, Vietnam and others, informs Dua. He says, "Domestic production constitutes a microscopic share in the overall supply with respect to the Indian market. The scenario is expected to more or less remain the same during the forecast period due to low degree of support from the gov-

Thermal technology is deemed one of the growing trends in the surveillance business. The thermal network camera is a perfect complement to any professional IP surveillance system as it can be seamlessly combined with existing equipment, and it is possible to secure an area or a perimeter that lies in complete darkness

ernment and lack of technical expertise for mass production."

The electronic security market has grown tremendously over the period of 2008 to 2013, informs Gupta, but domestic manufacturing of security and surveillance products has been a major challenge for companies since components are not available locally and about 60 per cent of the requirement is met by imports. He says, "The US, the UK and Israel are the major exporters of electronic security components and equipment to the country."

Government purchase fuelling demand

"From the aspect of strengthening internal security, various government

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